Twelve Reasons Why We Practice
(Donald Rothberg, November 2010)

1. We practice . . . because there is tremendous potential in the human heart, mind, and body, and we feel a longing to realize this potential—to touch a deep sense of peace, to open the heart wide, to have clarity and depth of mind.

2. We practice . . . because we are aware of many of the ways that we can be lost, confused, or deluded, not seeing clearly either ourselves or the world.

3. We practice . . . because we know that we suffer. We see how we get caught.

4. We practice . . . because our minds are dominated by many old patterns.

5. We practice . . . because there is great suffering in the world and a great need for wise and compassionate responses. (And there is also great potential for good, which is sometimes harder to see.)

6. We practice . . . because life is short, death is never too far away, and we remain stuck in different ways.

7. We practice . . . because we have a sense of the value of spiritual training; we have had some experience already of the benefits.

8. We practice . . . because we're willing to work hard.

9. We practice . . . because practice points to a wonderful, powerful way to live.

10. We practice . . . because we may have met some people who have practiced a lot and seem in some ways inspiring or exemplary.

11. We practice . . . because we want to serve others, and need training in order to do this effectively; we need a clear mind and open heart.

12. We practice . . . because something in our hearts says "yes," when we stop, listen, and ask about how to live, how to proceed.